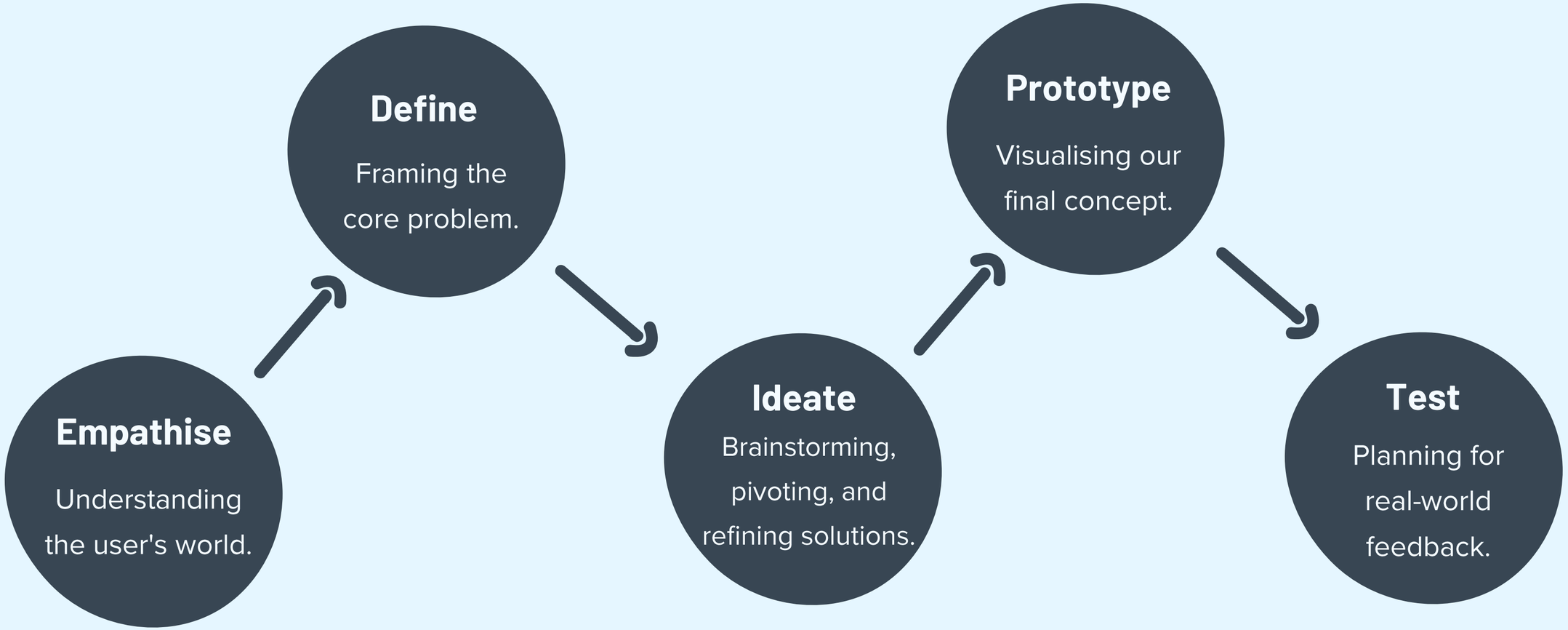


PetScape

Our Design Thinking Process

Our journey through the **five stages of Design Thinking** to create a pet care solution for India by 2030. We will show how our understanding evolved from initial user empathy to a refined, testable, and more user-centric final concept.



Empathize: Understanding the Urban Pet Parent

We began by creating an Empathy Map to immerse ourselves in the lives of urban Indian pet parents. This revealed a deep emotional conflict between their love for their pets and the constraints of their modern lifestyle.

Key Pains & Frustrations

1

Emotional Guilt

- Feeling anxious about leaving pets alone
- Feeling guilty for pets being alone in small apartments

2

Financial Guilt

- Struggling with the high costs of daycare, boarding, and other enrichment services.

3

Pet's Well-being

- Fearing their pets are developing boredom
- Concerned about signs of anxiety and destructive behaviours

Primary Goals (Gains)

1

- To feel like responsible, caring, and proactive "pet parents."

2

- To find affordable and reliable solutions that fit their busy schedules.

3

- To see their pets happy, healthy, and emotionally secure.

Define: Framing the Core Challenge

Synthesising our empathy research, we crafted a **Point of View (POV)** statement to give us a clear, actionable problem to solve.

Point of View (POV)

User — **Urban pet parents in India**

Need — a way to keep pets mentally engaged, active, and emotionally healthy at home

Blocker — limited time, small living spaces, high cost of existing solutions.

How Might We?

How might we enable urban pet parents to deliver immersive, affordable, and effective enrichment that alleviates both pet boredom and parent guilt?



Ideate (Part I): The Initial Concept & Critical Review

Amplified Guilt

Risked becoming a "digital babysitter," potentially worsening parent guilt.

High Barriers

Hardware cost and major safety concerns created barriers to affordability and adoption.

Low Feasibility

The technical hurdles were deemed too high for a safe, universally accepted product

Our initial brainstorming led to a futuristic idea: **PetScape VR**, a metaverse for pets using a custom headset.

However, upon critical review against our users' core needs, we identified significant issues:

Conclusion: The VR headset was a technology-first idea, not a user-first solution. We needed to pivot.



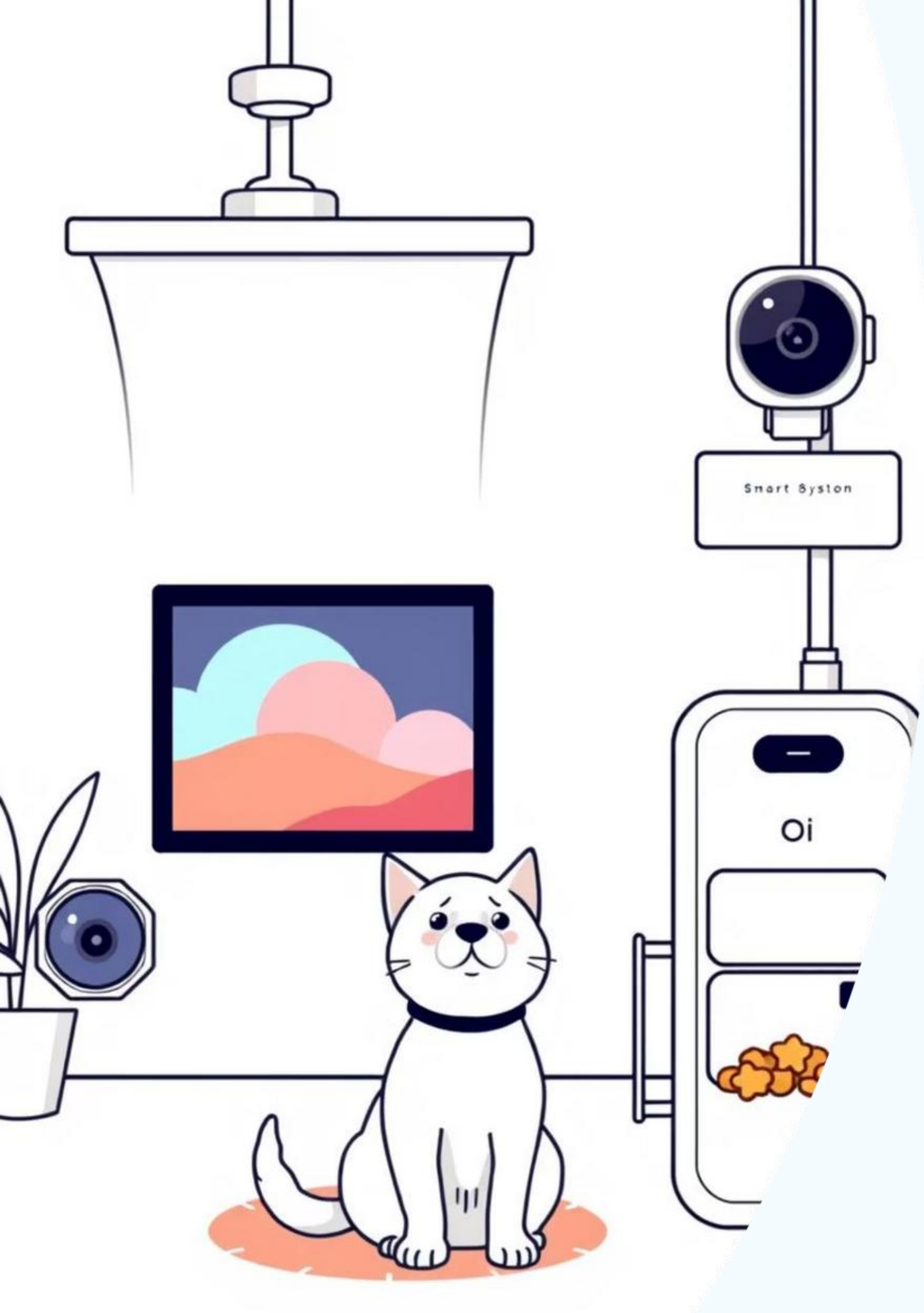
Ideate (Part II): A Better Solution - "PetScape PlayRoom"

We returned to the Ideate phase and used the SCAMPER method to develop a superior solution: **The PetScape PlayRoom**. Instead of putting a screen on the pet's face, we project an interactive world onto their environment.

The Concept: An integrated system that turns any room into an interactive smart playground for pets, controlled by the parent from anywhere.

Why it's Better:

Desirability	Viability	Feasibility
Transforms guilt into connection through remote, shared play. It's natural and non-invasive for the pet.	Built on mature, affordable technology (pico-projectors, AI cameras), allowing for a broader market.	Dramatically lower safety and liability risks, making it a realistic and scalable business.



Prototype: Visualizing the "PlayRoom" System

The Hardware Bundle:

Smart Projector

A compact, shelf-top projector that casts interactive games (chasing dots, virtual bugs) onto the floor.

AI Motion Camera

Tracks the pet's movement, registers gameplay, and monitors wellness. This also provides a live "Pet-Cam" feed to the owner's phone.

Smart Treat Dispenser

Syncs with the system to automatically reward successful play, reinforcing positive engagement.

Prototype: Real World Implementation



Prototype: The Software and Service Model



The experience is managed through a seamless app and a value-driven subscription model.

The "Co-Pilot" Mobile App

A user-friendly interface where parents can schedule play sessions, view the live Pet-Cam, manually control the projected games (like a virtual laser pointer), and receive AI-driven wellness reports.

The Subscription Service

A monthly subscription provides access to a constantly updated library of new games, advanced training modules, and personalized wellness insights generated by the AI camera.



7. Test: Our Validation Plan for the PlayRoom

1 Hypothesis 1: The Need (Unchanged)

- **We Believe:** Urban pet owners struggle with providing mental stimulation.
- **Test:** Survey 100 urban pet owners.
- **Criteria:** Over 60% report this struggle.

2 Hypothesis 2: The Value (Revised)

- **We Believe:** The PlayRoom reduces pet anxiety and owner guilt.
- **Test:** Offer trials to 50 pet owners.
- **Criteria:** Measure engagement time AND owner satisfaction with remote-play (target > 8/10).

3 Hypothesis 3: The Solution (Revised)

- **We Believe:** The projector-based games are engaging and effective.
- **Test:** A 4-week study with 30 diverse pets.
- **Criteria:** Track if interaction time improves week-over-week.



Conclusion & Next Steps

Our Design Thinking journey led us through a process of deep learning and critical iteration. By empathising with our users, we pivoted from a high-risk idea to develop the PetScape PlayRoom—a safer, more emotionally resonant, and highly feasible solution. It directly addresses the core needs of affordability, accessibility, and emotional fulfilment for both pet and parent.

Affordability → **Accessibility** → **Emotional Fulfillment**